

Exploring GPT4All, the Local LLM Desktop App

Developed by Nomic AI, GPT4All is a free-to-use, locally running chatbot that offers offline access, privacy, customisation and cost savings. And it does not need a graphics processing unit or GPU to function.



From the Stone Age to the Electronic and Information Age, humanity has seen significant technological advancements that make lives easier. Various AI tools are now available at our fingertips, with AI bots or assistants helping us plan our day by sending us reminders, answering questions, and much more. The remarkable capabilities of AI tools and applications include generating human-like text, language translation, creative content writing, content summarisation, and more.

Large language models or LLMs are powerful models trained on massive datasets that can produce human-like text. They can even help professionals at an advanced level, such as assisting in code generation, contributing to scientific research, etc.

State-of-the-art LLMs have a few limitations. They require costly

infrastructure, are dependent on the internet, and may not be secure or user-friendly. Imagine if you have an alternative AI tool that can run on your local machine, which is open source, free of charge, does not require an internet connection, and does not need any coding knowledge. Yes, you heard that right! This game-changer AI model is Nomic AI's 'GPT4All', the open source, local LLM desktop application.

What is GPT4All?

GPT4All is a free, open source platform created by Nomic AI (a company that builds tools for interacting with AI datasets and running AI models on consumer computers) to train and deploy powerful and customised LLMs that run locally on computers. In other words, it is a free-to-use, locally running, privacy-aware chatbot. The key highlight is that it doesn't require

any graphics processing unit (GPU) or internet connectivity.

Let's begin with how GPT4All stands out compared to the traditional LLMs, which require powerful servers in data centres, mostly cloud-based. When you use ChatGPT and provide a question or instruction as a prompt, the request is sent to OpenAI's servers via the internet. LLMs running on the servers process the request, and the response is sent back to the user. In contrast, GPT4All doesn't rely on any remote server, can work based on the local execution of LLMs, and runs the powerful AI models directly on the user's devices such as laptops, personal computers, and even mobiles or tablets.

Advantages of GPT4All

Privacy: When the LLM is run locally, there is no need to send precious data to any remote server. This means data